

Earthquake Preparedness Guide

Understanding Earthquakes

Earthquakes are sudden, rapid shaking of the ground caused by the shifting of rocks deep beneath the earth's surface. They can happen without warning and result in severe damage to infrastructure, loss of life, and significant disruptions to daily life. In earthquake-prone countries like the Philippines, preparedness and awareness are key to reducing risks and enhancing safety.

This guide outlines important steps to take before, during, and after an earthquake to help keep you and your family safe.

Before an Earthquake

- **Secure heavy furniture and appliances to walls.**
 - **Know the safe spots in each room:** under sturdy tables, against interior walls.
 - **Prepare an emergency kit** with food, water, medicine, and important documents.
 - **Identify safe evacuation routes and meeting places.**
 - **Learn how to turn off gas, water, and electricity.**
 - **Practice earthquake drills with your family.**
 - **Store breakable items in low or closed cabinets.**
 - **Ensure your home meets seismic safety standards.**
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During an Earthquake

- **DROP to the ground, COVER your head and neck, and HOLD ON to your shelter.**
 - **If indoors,** stay away from glass, windows, outside doors, and walls.
 - **Take cover under sturdy furniture** or protect your head with your arms.
 - **If outdoors,** move to an open area away from buildings, trees, and power lines.
 - **If in a vehicle,** pull over to a clear location and stop.
 - **Stay where you are until the shaking stops.**
 - **Be prepared for aftershocks.**
 - **Stay calm and reassure others.**
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After an Earthquake

- **Check yourself and others for injuries.**
 - **Look for and extinguish small fires.**
 - **Inspect your home for damage**, especially gas leaks and electrical system damage.
 - **Stay away from damaged areas and fallen power lines.**
 - **Be prepared for aftershocks.**
 - **Listen to a battery-operated radio** for emergency information.
 - **Avoid using the phone except for emergencies.**
 - **Check for structural damage before re-entering buildings.**
 - **Help others if you can**, especially the elderly and people with disabilities.
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Additional Resources

- **PHIVOLCS:** <https://www.phivolcs.dost.gov.ph>
- **NDRRMC:** <https://ndrrmc.gov.ph>
- **Red Cross Philippines:** <https://redcross.org.ph>
- Participate in earthquake drills and disaster awareness programs.

Preparedness saves lives. Stay alert, stay safe, and educate others.
